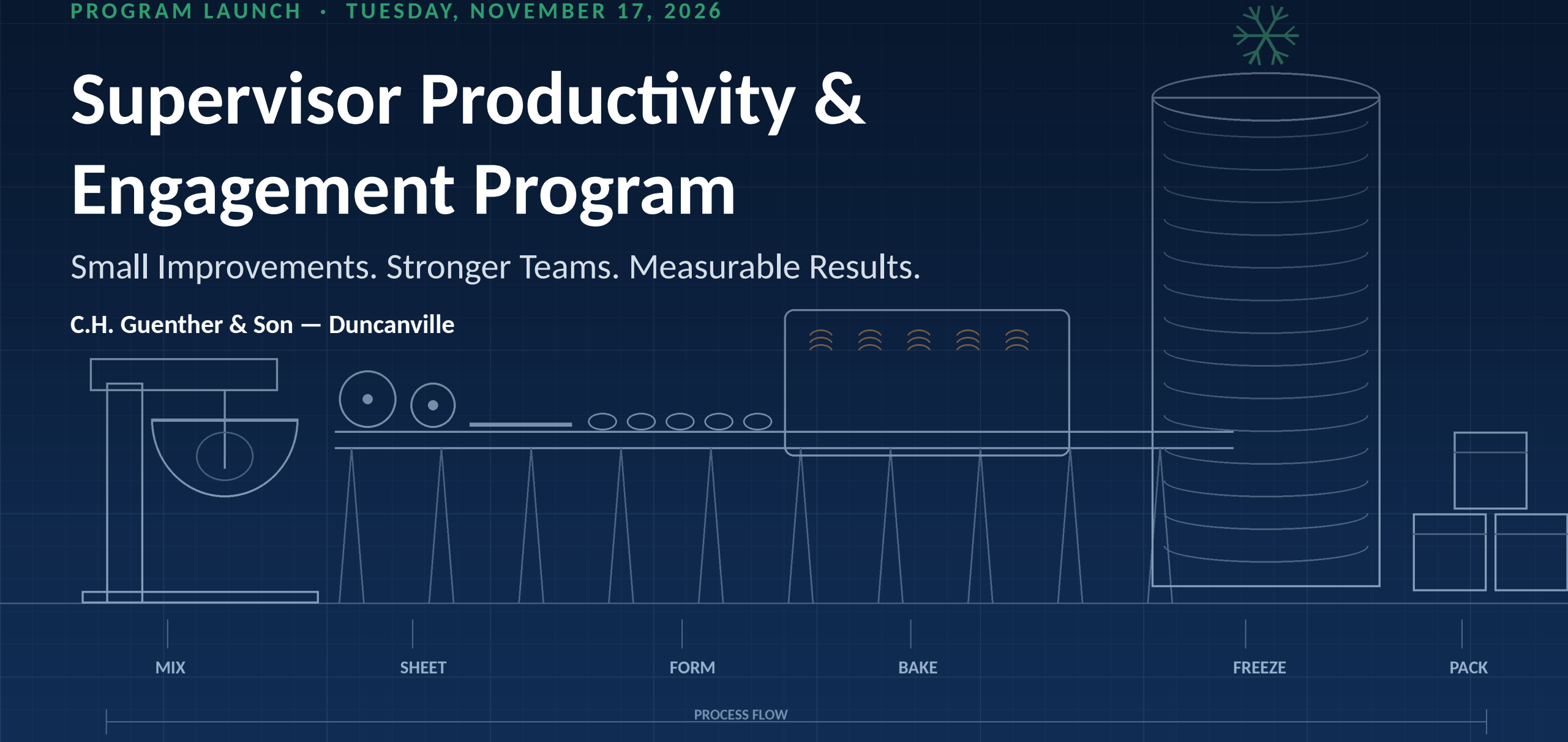
C.H. GUENTHER & SON | DUNCANVILLE

PROGRAM LAUNCH · TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 17, 2026

Supervisor Productivity & Engagement Program

Small Improvements. Stronger Teams. Measurable Results.

C.H. Guenther & Son — Duncanville



Three goals for this program

01

Empower supervisors

Supervisors lead real improvements on their own lines, with coaching and tools behind them.

02

Engage our people

Build employee engagement and teamwork across Production, Quality and Maintenance.

03

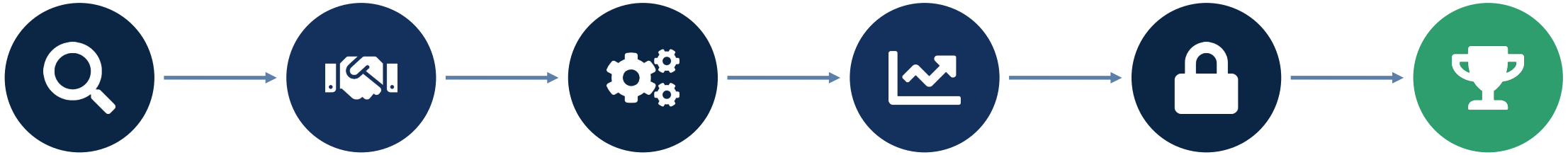
Improve performance

Deliver measurable gains in productivity, quality and cost, verified by data.

Continuous improvement belongs to everyone.

DISCUSS *What does "continuous improvement" look like on your shift today?*

Every improvement builds a leader



Identify
Spot a real problem on the floor

Engage
Bring the team into the fix

Improve
Test and implement the change

Measure
Prove it with before/after data

Sustain
Standardize so it sticks

Recognize
Celebrate the team's result

...and repeat, with a bigger problem each time

Leadership skills built along the way

- Problem solving with data
- Coaching and involving a team
- Presenting results to leadership

How our improvement cells work

Continuous Improvement coaches every cell: tools, methods and removing barriers

A Shift Improvement Cell

- **Production supervisor** — Project owner
- **Quality** — Food safety & specs
- **Maintenance** — Equipment expertise

B Shift Improvement Cell

- **Production supervisor** — Project owner
- **Quality** — Food safety & specs
- **Maintenance** — Equipment expertise

C Shift Improvement Cell

- **Production supervisor** — Project owner
- **Quality** — Food safety & specs
- **Maintenance** — Equipment expertise

Cross-shift projects: one shared owner, coordinated actions handed off across A, B and C shifts

Finance validates the financial results of every project

Who owns what?

Supervisors	Own the project, lead the team and present results	OWNS
Production employees	Identify opportunities and take part in improvements	PARTICIPATES
Quality	Protect quality and food-safety requirements in every change	SUPPORTS
Maintenance	Provide technical support and equipment expertise	SUPPORTS
Finance (Randy)	Review and validate financial savings	VALIDATES
CI Manager	Coach, provide tools, teach methods, remove barriers	COACHES
Plant leadership	Sponsor, recognize and support improvements	SPONSORS

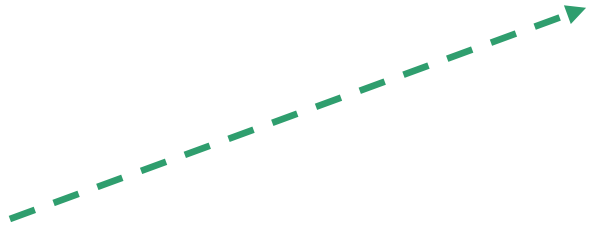
The supervisor leads.

CI coaches.

Ownership stays on the floor.

Start small, grow bigger

Skills, scope and value grow with every project



STAGE 1
Quick Wins

5S, visual management, workplace organization, simple changeover improvements

Scope: one area

STAGE 2
Process Improvements

Recurring downtime, setup losses, waste and rework

Scope: one process or line

STAGE 3
Larger Projects

Cross-functional productivity, standardization and verified cost reduction

Scope: cross-functional

DISCUSS *What Stage 1 quick win could your shift finish in the next two weeks?*

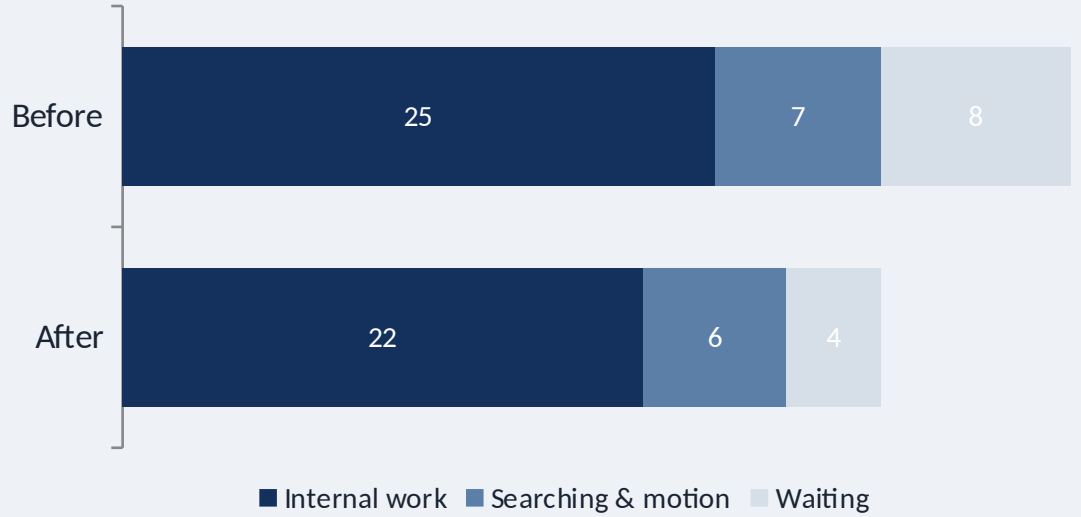
Changeover: get back to good product faster

1. Establish the current baseline
2. Observe the actual changeover
3. Find waiting, motion and prep waste
4. Apply basic SMED principles
5. Standardize the improved method
6. Verify over repeated changeovers

SMED basics: do prep while the line is still running, stage tools and parts before stopping, and cut waiting between hand-offs.

Changeover time, minutes

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — NOT PLANT DATA



40 → 32 min 8 minutes back per changeover (20%) in this example

Hypothetical numbers to show the method. Your baseline comes from your own observed changeovers.

FOCUS AREA 2

5S: a place for everything, and food safe

Sort

Remove unneeded tools, parts and supplies from the line

Set in Order

Shadow boards and labeled homes for change parts and tools

Shine

Clean and inspect equipment, linked to the sanitation plan

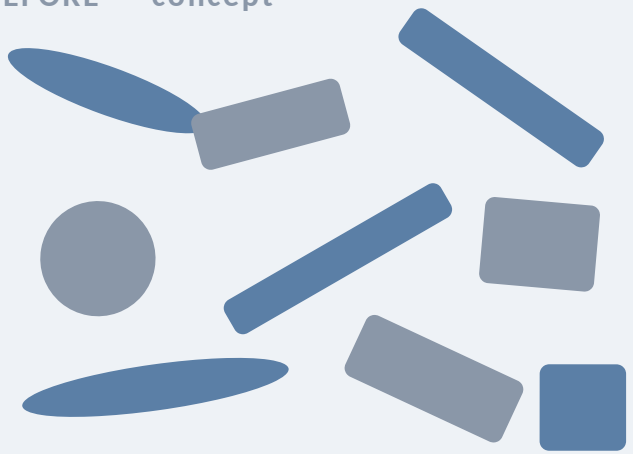
Standardize

Visual labels, color codes and one-point lessons

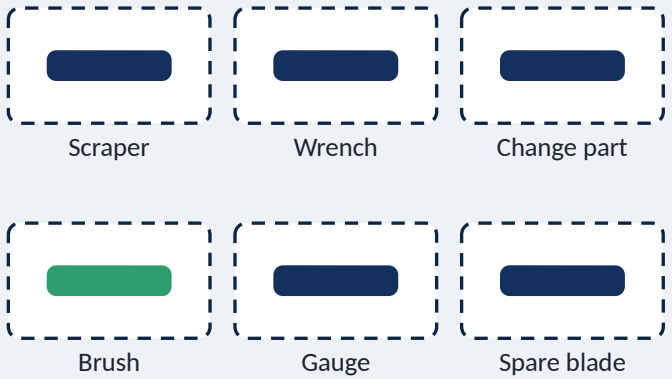
Sustain

Routine audits and supervisor walk-throughs

BEFORE · concept



AFTER · shadow board concept



Food safety first

- Follow our sanitation program and approved chemicals
- Keep food-contact and non-contact tools separate
- Use the plant's color code; never invent a new one
- Use cleanable, approved materials for boards and labels

FOCUS AREA 3

Employee engagement: the people closest to the work

Ask what slows them down
Start every project by asking operators where the pain is

Encourage suggestions
Make it easy and safe to raise an idea, big or small

Recognize contributions
Name the people behind the idea, in front of their peers

Give ownership
Let employees own specific improvement actions

Share across shifts
Spread what works from A to B to C shift

> **People support what they help improve.**
>
> When operators shape the change, they keep it going after the project ends.

DISCUSS *What's one thing that slows your team down every single shift?*

How to select a project

ALL IDEAS

Safe No added risk to people or food safety

Small enough to complete Can close in weeks, not months

Measurable Clear baseline and a number to move

Within our influence The team can change it directly

Valuable to operations Output, quality or cost

Resourced People, parts and time are available

Our first project

Good first projects

- Stage change parts before one product changeover
- Shadow board for one line's tools
- Cut one recurring jam on one machine

Too big for a first project

- Redesign the whole packaging area
- Replace major equipment
- Anything needing capital approval

DISCUSS *Run your idea through the funnel. Where does it get stuck?*

Seven steps, one simple PDCA cycle

PLAN | DO | CHECK | ACT



1 — Identify a problem
What's hurting us?

2 — Define the baseline
How bad is it today?

3 — Set a measurable target
What does good look like?

4 — Engage the team
Who needs to be involved?

5 — Implement the improvement
What are we changing?

6 — Verify the results
Did it really work?

7 — Present and sustain
How do we keep it?

CI coaching at every step. Bring your project to a coaching session at the baseline, the target and the verification steps. These are the points where most projects go off track.

What we measure, and what counts as savings

OPERATIONAL GAINS · measured by the team on the floor

Changeover minutes
Last good to first good product

Downtime minutes
Unplanned stops by cause

Scrap & rework
Pounds, units or cases lost

Employee participation
Ideas raised, people involved

5S audit results
Score against the area standard

Action completion
Actions closed on time

Financial benefits

Validated by Finance

Operational gains are real, but they only become reported savings once Finance confirms the money actually changed.

Operational gain = the process got better. **Realized savings** = the cost actually went down and Finance agrees.

DISCUSS *Which of these measures could you start tracking on your line this week?*

Turning improvements into verified value

Baseline → Improvement → Measured benefit → Finance review → Validated savings

Hard savings

Spending actually goes down: less overtime, material or scrap cost.

Reported as savings

Cost avoidance

A future cost we prevented, such as avoided repairs or added spend.

Reported separately

Capacity / productivity

Time or output freed up. Value depends on how we use it.

Reported as capacity

Nonfinancial

Safety, food safety, ergonomics, morale, ease of work.

Reported as impact

Saved time ≠ saved money. Minutes saved become labor savings only when paid hours actually come out (for example less overtime). Otherwise they are capacity, which is valuable, but different.

Your project. Your results. Your presentation.

Every project presentation answers six questions:

1. What problem did we identify?
2. What was the baseline?
3. What did the team change?
4. What were the results?
5. What financial value was validated?
6. How will we sustain the improvement?

Presented by the supervisor, at the existing WOr leadership meeting.

PROJECT ONE-PAGER · SAMPLE TEMPLATE Cell: [A Shift] Owner: [Supervisor]

1 · Problem

[Describe the problem in one sentence]

2 · Baseline

[Measured starting point + how measured]

3 · What we changed

[Key countermeasures, who did them]

4 · Results

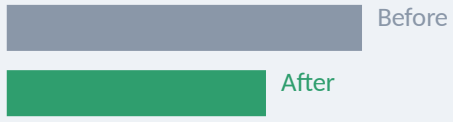


Chart of your measured results

5 · Validated value

[Finance-reviewed category & amount]

6 · Sustain plan

[Standard work, audit, owner]

ROADMAP

Our first 90 days

DAYS 1–30 Launch

- Confirm cells and owners
- Select first projects
- Establish baselines
- Complete initial quick wins

DAYS 31–60 Build

- Review early results
- Strengthen problem solving
- Expand practices that work
- Share wins across shifts

DAYS 61–90 Sustain & grow

- Standardize improvements
- Develop larger opportunities
- Recognize successful teams
- Plan the next cycle

Suggested CI coaching checkpoints

Weekly, per cell (suggested): 20–30 minutes at the line

Leadership reviews

Day 30 review

Day 60 review

Day 90 review & recognition

Every Shift. Every Team. Every Improvement Counts.

1. **Confirm cell members**
2. **Identify one opportunity per cell**
3. **Assign a supervisor project owner**
4. **Establish baseline data**
5. **Schedule the first CI coaching session**

We are not launching another reporting exercise.

We are building leaders who improve the business.

APPENDIX

Tools and templates for supervisors

- **A1** Sample project charter
- **A2** Example changeover project
- **A3** Example 5S project
- **A4** Suggested supervisor KPIs
- **A5** Project selection scoring matrix
- **A6** Example financial savings calculation

All numbers in the appendix are illustrative examples, not C.H. Guenther plant data.

APPENDIX A1

Sample project charter

Project title	*[Short, specific name, e.g. "Line __ product changeover"]*	**Project owner**	*[Supervisor name]*
Cell / shift	*[A / B / C, or cross-shift]*	**Team members**	*[Production, Quality, Maintenance, operators]*
Problem statement	*[What is happening, where, since when, and why it matters]*	**CI coach**	*[CI Manager]*
Baseline	*[Current measured value, how and when measured]*	**Finance reviewer**	Randy (Finance)
Target	*[Measurable goal and date]*	**Food-safety check**	*[Quality sign-off required? Y/N]*
Scope: in / out	*[What is included; what is not]*	**Key dates**	*[Start · baseline · review · WOr]*
Expected benefit type	*[Hard savings / cost avoidance / capacity / nonfinancial]*	**Risks & support**	*[Barriers CI should help remove]*

Template fields in [brackets] are filled in by the project owner. Keep the whole charter to one page.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — NOT PLANT DATA

Example changeover project

Step	What the team did (example)	Example result
Baseline	Timed 5 changeovers on one line, last good to first good product	**Average 40 min**
Observe	Filmed one changeover with crew consent; mapped every task	**Found 8 min of waiting**
Separate	Split tasks into internal (line stopped) and external (line running)	**6 tasks movable to external**
Improve	Pre-staged parts cart, pre-set guides, Maintenance on standby	**Waiting and motion cut**
Standardize	One-page changeover checklist, trained all three shifts	**Same method A/B/C**
Verify	Timed the next 10 changeovers	**Average 32 min, held**

Reported as: 8 min of capacity per changeover. Becomes hard savings only if Finance confirms paid hours came out (e.g. reduced overtime).

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — NOT PLANT DATA

Example 5S project: changeover tool station

Sort	Red-tagged unused tools and obsolete change parts with the crew
Set in Order	Shadow board at point of use; labeled bins for change parts
Shine	Cleaning and inspection added to sanitation checklist (with Quality)
Standardize	Photo standard posted; plant color code for food-contact tools
Sustain	Weekly 5-minute supervisor audit; score posted at the station

Example measures

Tool search time

e.g. 4 min → under 1 min

5S audit score

e.g. 2.1 → 4.0 of 5

Missing-tool events

e.g. tracked weekly

Benefit type: mostly capacity and nonfinancial (safety, food safety, morale).

APPENDIX A4

Suggested supervisor KPIs

KPI	Definition	Source	Suggested review
Changeover time	Minutes from last good to first good product	Line logs / timed observation	Per changeover; weekly trend
Unplanned downtime	Minutes of unplanned stops, by top cause	Downtime tracking	Daily; weekly Pareto
Scrap & rework	Product lost or reworked (lb, units or cases)	Production / Quality records	Daily; weekly trend
5S audit score	Score against the area standard	Supervisor / cell audit	Weekly
Employee participation	Ideas raised; employees involved in actions	Cell idea log	Weekly
Action completion	% of project actions closed on time	Project action list	Weekly at coaching
Validated value	Finance-reviewed benefit by category	Finance (Randy)	At project close

Suggested starting set: use the one or two KPIs that fit your project, and use existing plant data sources where they exist.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCORES — EXAMPLE IDEAS

Project selection scoring matrix

Criterion (score 1–5)	Weight	Idea A: stage change parts	Idea B: fix recurring jam	Idea C: redesign pack area
Safe (gate: must pass)	Pass/Fail	Pass	Pass	Pass
Small enough to complete	x3	5	3	1
Measurable	x2	5	4	3
Within team's influence	x3	5	4	2
Value to operations	x2	3	4	5
Resources available	x1	4	3	2
Weighted total (max 55)		**50**	**40**	**27**

How to use: any idea that fails the safety gate is out. Score the rest 1–5 as a team, multiply by the weight, and start with the highest total. In this example, Idea A becomes the first project and Idea C is parked for Stage 3.

ILLUSTRATIVE — ALL INPUTS HYPOTHETICAL

Example financial savings calculation

Step	Calculation (example inputs)	Result
Time saved per changeover	40 min baseline − 32 min verified	**8 min**
Annual changeovers (assumed)	5 per week × 50 weeks	**250**
Line time freed	8 min × 250 ÷ 60	**≈ 33 line hours**
Crew labor hours (assumed crew of 6)	33.3 h × 6 people	**≈ 200 labor hours**
Potential value (assumed $30/h loaded rate)	200 h × $30	**≈ $6,000 potential**

If paid hours do NOT change

Report ≈ 33 line hours of capacity. Hard savings = $0 until the capacity is used, for example to absorb volume without overtime.

If Finance confirms hours came out

e.g. overtime reduced by a matching amount: the confirmed amount is reported as validated hard savings.